common ground with the United States. In this context, as Robert Keohane and Beth Simmons find, "states pursue their values in world politics but do so strategically to maximize benefits to themselves . . . ."[22] The BRICS' incentives to support collective action come from the same logic as Erik Voeten finds in the active collaboration among states lacking many common interests "other than a common aversion of Western hegemony and the principles associated with that." Such states may constitute a "counter-hegemonic bloc" to offset the dominance of the United States.[23]

Voeten's conclusion emerges from his observation that countries with different values and political regime types cooperate in global governance institutions, such as the United Nations, World Trade Organization (WTO), and G20. For example, the U.N. Security Council (UNSC) achieved consensus on more than 93 percent of resolutions adopted between 2000 and December 15, 2013—an increase from 88.9 percent in the 1990s, when the UNSC was very active after the end of the Cold War. This high level of consensus reflects a decrease in China's abstentions and a concentration of nonconsensus resolutions on divisions pertaining to the Middle East (e.g., resolutions on Syria or the 2003 Iraq war) and the Balkans.[24] A more rigorous examination of UNSC voting patterns reveals a pattern that does not uniformly reflect the democracy/nondemocracy cleavage. Although Latin America hews closer to the West in voting patterns, Russia and the former Soviet republics are positioned between the Western and the non-Western worlds, similar to Turkey and South Korea. The non-Western group includes not only the remaining communist states (China, North Korea, Vietnam, Laos, and Cuba), but also Afghanistan, India, and Pakistan, among others.[25]

These findings reinforce other work that shows the relevance of common aversions for giving the original four BRICs a sense of purpose.[26] *Common aversions* are conceptualized as situations in which actors seek to avoid a particular outcome. Typically, the actors do not necessarily prefer the same outcome, but they agree that there is at least one or more results that they all want to avoid. Coordination may help them collaborate when they confront common aversions.[27] Communiqués from the BRICS' early meetings and interviews with Russian officials involved in the process suggest that common aversions were among the first impulses to consult and coordinate on important international governance issues.[28]